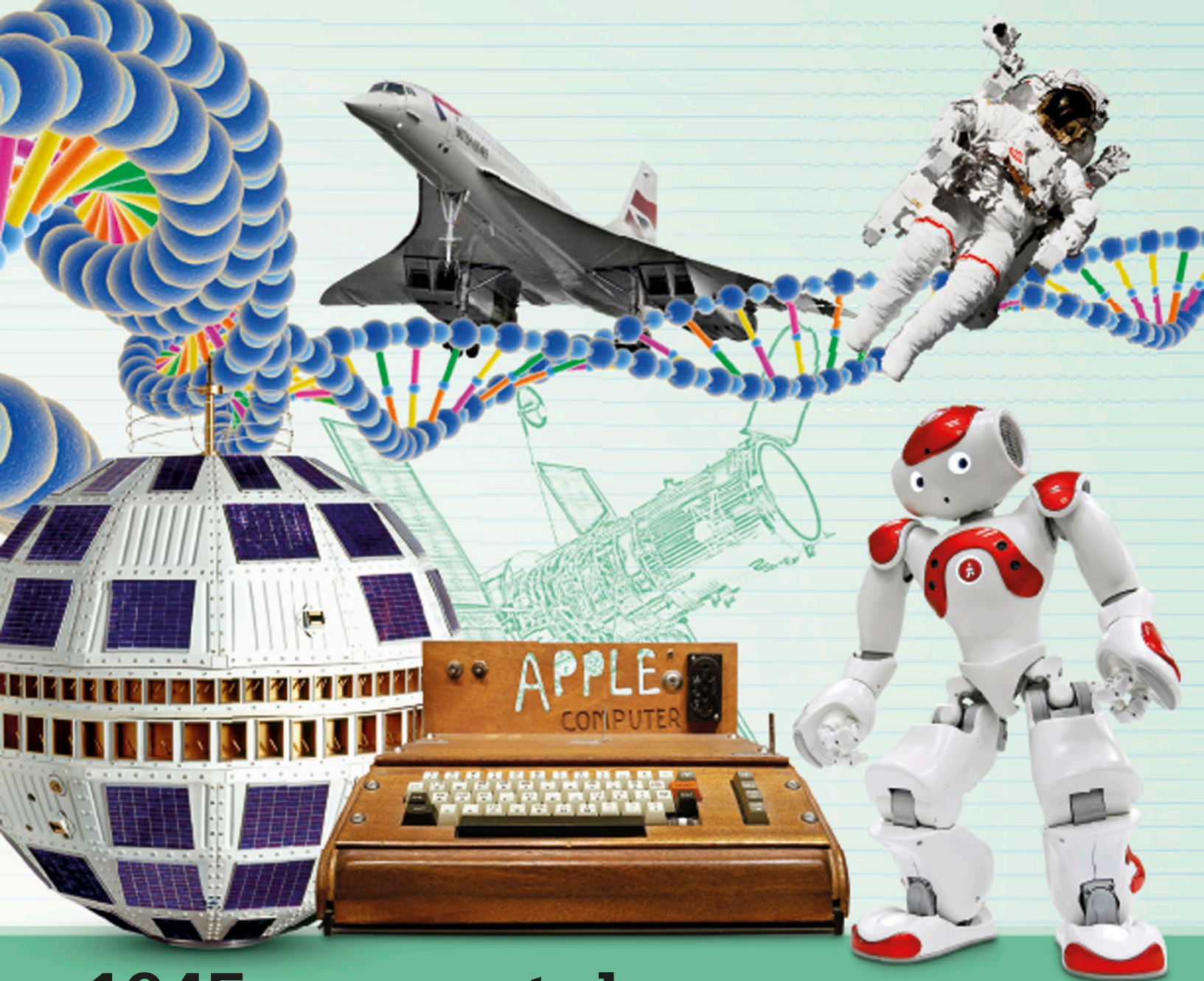




1945–present day Modern science

This era began with the first computers, some of which were the size of a basketball court, and were very slow and unreliable. The invention of the transistor soon enabled devices to be built that were far smaller and faster, and more powerful and efficient. Further strides in technology saw thousands and later millions of electronic circuits shrunk onto a single silicon chip, spurring the arrival of robots, smartphones, and computer technology in cars and many household appliances. Computing power became available to all, aided by advances in communications and the rise of the Internet.